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Project Management 7.6

Project Evaluation – Success or Failure?

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this week, you will be able to:
  - Give relevant evaluation examples
  - Recognise success and failure
  - Plan for success

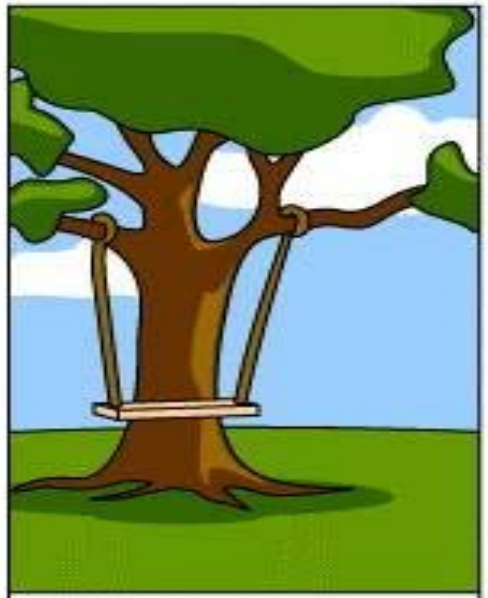
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Project Evaluation

- The organisation will want to evaluate whether the project it has authorised using scarce resources has been successful
- The key reference document is what we committed to at the outset; in the business case (plus any authorised changes since)
- Complicated projects may have several criteria to measure against so it is important that we know what project success looks like.



How the customer explained it



How the Project Leader understood it



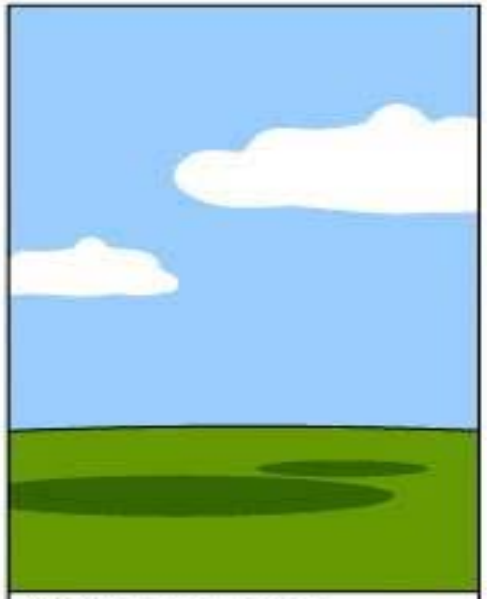
How the Analyst designed it



How the Programmer wrote it



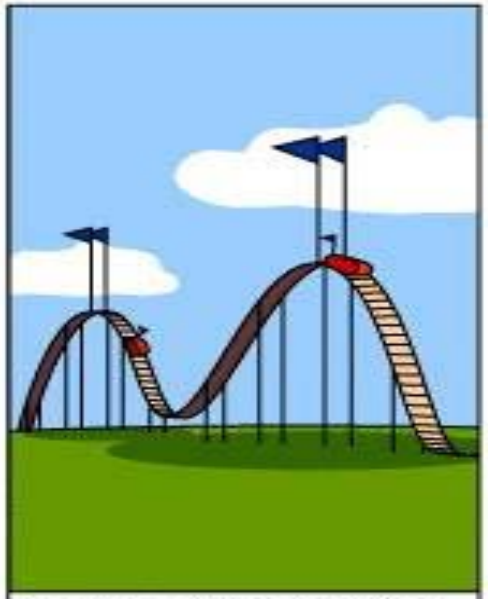
How the Business Consultant described it



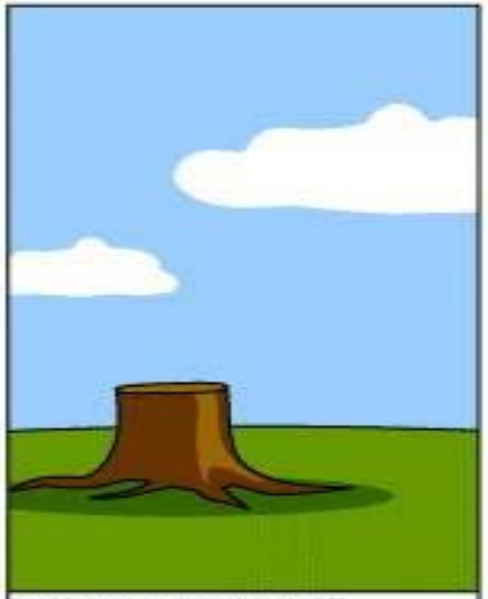
How the project was documented



What operations installed



How the customer was billed



How it was supported



What the customer really needed

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Success

- **What Does Success Look Like?**
  - Clear vision of what it wants to accomplish.
  - Alignment of the benefits to the vision
  - Committed
  - Leverage benefits.

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Success

- **What does this mean for the project?**
  - Were we clear about what we wanted to accomplish and did we have a viable strategy for turning our vision into a reality.
  - If we didn’t know exactly where we wanted to go, how could we possibly have designed a good strategy for getting here?
  - The reliability of the project strategy is directly related to the clarity of the vision.

Success or Failure?



Spinnaker Tower, Portsmouth

‘One of the longest running and overdue projects in the U.K, the Spinnaker Tower in Portsmouth has finally opened to the public many years behind schedule. Originally planned to open in 1999 around the same time as the London Eye, the opening has been delayed almost six years thanks to a string of design and construction delays.’ (Skyscraper News 2005).

2005 APM Project Manager of the Year Runner Up
2006 RICS Project of the Year

Success or Failure?



Hoover Dam Nr. Las Vegas

Completed 2 years early and under budget in 1935. The highest damn in the world when constructed at over 700 feet high. Attracts 10 million visitors every year.

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Planning for Success

- If we want to be capable of clarity in the PIR we need to have developed a clear vision and put it into action during the project:
  - Rather than just thinking about the capabilities the project will bring, focus on identifying the reasons the organisation values them.
  - Why is the capability important to the organisation and how will it add value?
  - How will this capability contribute to the organisation's ability to deliver benefit when combined with behavioral changes? What are the organisation's deeper motives?

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Look Forward

- L7.7 The project closure